2026 Lows

Dow below 47K. S&P –1.52%. Brent closes at $100. New supreme leader vows Hormuz stays shut.

MARKETS

ALL THREE INDEXES HIT 2026 CLOSING LOWS. S&P –1.52% to 6,672. Dow –1.54%, falling below 47,000 for the first time this year. Nasdaq –1.78%. Russell –2.15%. UVXY surged 9.86%. Brent crude settled above $100 for the first time since August 2022. The IEA's 400M barrel release and the US SPR release of 172M barrels—the largest coordinated intervention in history—failed to hold the line. The market has stopped believing in policy solutions and is pricing in a sustained supply crisis.

The catalyst: Iran's new supreme leader Mojtaba Khamenei issued his first statement, vowing to keep the Strait of Hormuz closed as a tool to pressure the enemy and continue attacks on Gulf Arab neighbors. That single statement sent WTI up 9.72% to $95.73 and Brent up 9.22% to $100.46. USO +9.57%, BNO +9.56% this morning. Energy was the only green sector (+0.93%). Everything else bled: industrials –2.51%, discretionary –2.30%, tech –1.84%.

In a stunning policy reversal, the US eased sanctions on Russian oil to help offset the Iran supply shock. An Iran-backed Iraqi group claimed responsibility for downing a US military aircraft—the conflict is expanding beyond Iran's borders. Trump told reporters we've got to finish the job but his aides are reportedly vying to affect the outcome, suggesting internal debate about an exit.

10-year yield rose to 4.26%—highest since early February. 30-year mortgage rates jumped to 6.11%, the biggest weekly increase since the Liberation Day tariff shock. Rate cut odds: zero for March, barely above coin-flip for September. The market is pricing in just one cut for all of 2026, down from three a month ago. TLT –0.20%—bonds continue to sell as inflation expectations reset higher.

PCE data at 8:30 AM today—January data, won't capture the oil spike. But it sets the pre-war inflation baseline. FOMC meets next week. GTC Monday. Adobe earnings last night.

> ***IOWN Tactical: S&P at 6,673 (SPY $666.06). Down ~13% from January ATH of 7,003. The 200-day moving average is at ~6,596—hasn't been broken in 10 months. That's the technical line in the sand. Our –20% buy trigger is at ~5,600. We're not there yet, but the pace of decline is accelerating. If the 200DMA breaks, the next support is 6,400. Research Reveals Opportunities—but patience is a discipline.***

IOWN HOLDINGS: THE SESSION

ENERGY VS. EVERYTHING. Top 5: CVX +2.70% ($196.97), MARA +2.46% ($8.76), VLO +2.06% ($235.81), ATO +1.35% ($186.79), FTNT +1.10% ($84.40). The pattern is clear: energy and cybersecurity are the only safe ground. MARA's presence in the top 5 is notable—crypto miners catching a bid as BTC holds near $70K while equities collapse.

The carnage deepened: TSM –5.03% ($336.71)—Taiwan Semi getting hit hardest among our semis on global demand fears. STLD –4.97% ($175.10)—steel in freefall, down nearly $25 from its March 4 level. SUPV –5.08% ($8.78), HUT –5.05% ($48.54), ATAT –4.60% ($34.64). The bottom 5 are all down 4.5%+ in a single session.

Semis broadly crushed: ADI –3.74% ($307.27), LRCX –4.29% ($209.49), AMD –3.46% ($197.74), NXPI –4.33% ($191.22), NVDA –1.55% ($183.14). NVDA is holding relatively better—the GTC premium is providing a floor. But the rest of the semi sleeve is repricing for a global slowdown.

Dividend strategy taking heavy damage: TEL –3.56%, FAST –2.88%, ADP –2.61%, SYK –2.48%, QCOM –2.21%, GPC –2.01%, ABT –1.91%, CL –1.85%. Defense held: LMT +0.52%, GD +0.39%. Utilities and staples were mixed: BKH +0.74%, NEE flat, but most consumer staples sold.

> ***Benchmarks: DVY –0.40%, IWS –1.65%, IUSG –1.74%. Growth getting destroyed. Value holding up better because of energy and utility weightings. Our dividend strategy is outperforming our growth hybrid this week for the first time since the war began. Diversification doing its job. Think Like an Owner.***

DIGITAL ASSETS

IBIT –0.30% ($39.95). ETHA –0.38% ($15.63). Crypto flatlining while equities crash. That's relative outperformance. The S&P is down 1.52% and BTC is barely red. MARA +2.46% shows the crypto-mining bid is alive. BTC holding $70K through $100 Brent oil is a structural statement.

Fear & Greed at 15—Extreme Fear. The range this month: 8 to 22, never leaving Extreme Fear. 15M Iranians—16% of the population—hold crypto as a hedge against currency collapse. The rial has fallen 98% vs the dollar over the past decade. This is the real-world use case for decentralized money, playing out in real-time.

GEOPOLITICS

DAY 14. MOJTABA KHAMENEI'S FIRST STATEMENT: HORMUZ STAYS CLOSED. Iran's new supreme leader is doubling down on the economic warfare strategy. Keep the Strait shut, attack Gulf neighbors, let oil prices crush the West into forcing a ceasefire. It's working—Brent at $100 is the proof. The US eased Russian oil sanctions in response, a remarkable policy reversal that shows how desperate the energy situation has become.

An Iran-backed Iraqi group downed a US military aircraft—the war is metastasizing beyond Iran proper. Trump's aides are reportedly divided on the endgame. The UK economy ground to a halt even before the energy shock. India's rupee hit a record low. Gas nationally at $3.54 and heading for $4+. The EU warned inflation could surpass 3% if Brent stays near $100.

The reserve math: IEA 400M barrels + US SPR 172M = 572M barrels. Global consumption is 105M bpd. Hormuz normally handles ~20M bpd. At current disruption levels, 572M barrels buys roughly 28 days. The clock started Wednesday. If Hormuz doesn't reopen by mid-April, reserves are depleted and oil goes to $120+ again.

ON OUR RADAR

1. The 200DMA at 6,596 is the line. S&P at 6,673—just 77 points above. This level hasn't been broken in 10 months. If it fails, the next support is 6,400 (November lows). Our –20% buy trigger is ~5,600—still 16% below. Don't front-run the signal. Patience is a discipline.

2. PCE at 8:30 AM is today's data event. January data—pre-war baseline. If it confirms the CPI Goldilocks (2.4–2.5% range), the Fed has room. If it surprises hot, the last rate cut hope evaporates. FOMC meets next week—this is the final data point they'll see.

3. GTC Monday is the growth stock lifeline. Jensen Huang's keynote has historically been NVDA's biggest catalyst of the year. If he delivers a blockbuster AI roadmap, semis could decouple from the oil trade. Our NVDA ($183.14), AMD ($197.74), TSM ($336.71), LRCX ($209.49) are all down 15–25% from recent highs. GTC is the potential inflection.

4. Energy is the portfolio's anchor. CVX +2.70%, VLO +2.06%, CNX +0.86%, OKE –0.97%. In a portfolio where the average holding is down 2–3%, energy is flat to up. This is exactly why we own these names. Avoid Erosion is not just about avoiding bad companies—it's about owning businesses that protect you when everything else breaks.

5. US easing Russian sanctions is a regime shift. The fact that the US is willing to ease sanctions on Russia—in the middle of an ongoing Ukraine conflict—to offset the Iran oil shock tells you how severe the energy crisis is. This is a structural positive for global oil supply if it holds. Watch for further policy pivots.

6. The war's internal politics are shifting. Trump aides are vying to affect the outcome. The exit debate is real. If a ceasefire framework emerges this weekend, Monday opens with a face-ripping rally. If not, the 200DMA test comes next week. Either way—GTC Monday, FOMC Wednesday. The next five trading days will define Q1.

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